FIRST PETER

Conversational Version

Salutation

1:1 Peter, apostle of Jesus Christ[Messiah], to the Chosen who live as foreigners in the Dispersion throughout Pontus, Galatia, Cappadocia, Asia, and Bithynia, **2**known by God the Father a long time ago, sanctified by *his* Spirit, sprinkled with Christ's blood, and obedient to him. Grace and peace many times over. **1 Pet 1:1-2**

Gratitude for Heaven Offered

3Blessed *be* the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ. In his great mercy, he gave us a living hope by resurrecting Jesus. **4**He has reserved for us in heaven an inheritance that doesn't deteriorate, that can't be defiled and won't fade away. **5**Trusting his power protects us so we can receive the salvation that's ready for him to reveal in the end.

6With that to look forward to, rejoice, even though for a little while now, various trials may be bringing you grief. **7**Your faith is worth more than gold that perishes. Testing that faith—as if by fire—leads to praising, exalting, and honoring Jesus Christ when he returns. **8**Though you haven't seen him, you love him. Because you believe in him, your joy is so great and glorious that you can't express it. **9**In the end, your faith will save your souls. **1 Pet 1:3-9**

The Prophets' Ministry to Us

10Prophets who prophesied about the grace that *would come* to you searched out this salvation carefully. **11**They wanted to find out what time or what kind of time the Spirit of Christ in them was indicating about his sufferings and subsequent glories. **12**They learned that they weren't ministering these things to themselves, but to you. The Holy Spirit, sent from heaven, has announced those things now through your evangelists—things angels long to look into.

13So think straight and be serious. Put your hope completely in the grace that will come to you when Jesus Christ appears. **14**Like obedient children, don't conform to the desires you lived by in your former ignorance; **15**conform yourselves to the Holy One that called you to become holy in everything you do. **16**Like scripture says, ***"Be holy because I'm holy"*** **[Lev 11:44-45; 19:2; 20:7].** **1 Pet 1:10-16**

Hope Based on Spiritual Things

17You call him Father who judges impartially each person's work; so, like foreigners, live out your time here in fear. **18**You weren't redeemed with corruptible things—silver or gold—from the empty life you inherited from your ancestors. **19**You were redeemed with the precious

blood of the unblemished Lamb. [20]Christ was foreknown before the founding of the world but was revealed in the last times. [21]Through him you're faithful to God, who resurrected him and glorified him. So, your faith and hope lie in God. [22]You've cleaned up your lives by obeying the truth in brotherly love; continue to love each other with a pure heart. [23]You've been born again from incorruptible seed through God's living, lasting message:

[24]***"Flesh is like grass;***
its beauty is like blossoms in the grass.
The grass dries up;
the blossoms fall off;
[25]***but what the LORD says lasts forever"*** **[Is 40:6-8].**

That's the message we presented to you. **1 Pet 1:17-25**

The Cornerstone

2:[1]So, get rid of hate, deceit, hypocrisy, jealousy, insults. [2]Like newborn babies, be hungry for pure spiritual milk so you can grow up to salvation—[3]if you've tasted how good the Lord is. [4]Come to him as to a living stone, rejected by people, but chosen and precious to God. [5]Like living stones you're building yourselves up into a spiritual house for a holy priesthood that offers spiritual sacrifices to God through Christ. [6]So it stands in scripture,

"I'm laying a stone in Zion,
a precious cornerstone.
He won't disappoint the ones that trust in him" **[Is 28:16].**

[7]To you believers *he's* precious, but to disbelievers *he's*

"a stone the builders rejected
that has become the cornerstone" **[Ps 118:22];**

[8]and

"a stone they trip over,
a rock that makes them fall" **[Is 8:14].**

They "trip" by disobeying the message—as they were allowed to do. **1 Pet 2:1-8**

Living in Light of Who You Are

[9]But you're **a chosen race [Is 43:20], a royal priesthood, a holy nation [Ex 19:6], a people that belongs to God. That's so you can present *to others* the excellence [Is 43:21]** of the One that called you out of darkness into his amazing light.

[10]*"You that weren't a people at one time*
are now God's people;
you that he hadn't shown mercy
have now received it" **[Hos 2:23].** **1 Pet 2:9-10**

[11]I urge you, like foreigners here temporarily, to stay away from physical drives that fight against the soul. [12]Keep your lifestyle good among the Gentiles so whatever they'd slander you for, when they observe the good things you do, they'll praise God in the end.

Societal Virtues

[13]Submit to human institutions for the Lord's sake—[14]to the king in authority or his governors sent to punish the bad and praise the good. [15]God wants you to silence the ignorance of bad people by doing good. [16]You're free, but freedom doesn't mean you can do as you please; you're God's servants. [17]Respect everybody, love Christ's family, respect God, honor the king.
1 Pet 2:11-17

[18]Servants, defer to your masters with respect, not just the good and considerate ones, but the harsh ones *too*. [19]This pleases God: suffering unjustly and bearing it for conscience sake toward him. [20]What's notable about suffering for sin and bearing it? But suffering for doing good and bearing it, pleases him. [21]That's what he's called you to. Even Christ suffered; he did it for you and left footprints for you to step in. [22]He ***"didn't sin or deceive"*** **[Is 53:9].** [23]When he was insulted, he didn't insult back. When he suffered, he didn't threaten. He turned himself over to the One who judges justly. [24]He humbly bore your sins in his body on the cross so you would live right; his wounds healed you. [25]You were wandering off like sheep, but you've returned to the Shepherd and Overseer of your souls. **1 Pet 2:18-25**

Family Virtues

3:[1]Wives, defer to your husbands so even if they don't believe the message, your conduct will win them over aside from it [2]as they watch your innocent, respectful behavior. [3]For beauty, don't rely on external things like elaborately braided hair or the gold or clothes you wear. [4]Root your beauty in the inner self as in a gentle, quiet spirit; that's especially precious to God. [5]That's the way holy women who hoped in God used to adorn themselves in respect for their husbands. [6]Sarah respected Abraham and called him Sir [lord]. You're her daughters. if you do good and feel secure in your situation. **1 Pet 3:1-6**

[7]Husbands, live with your wives with the understanding that they are weaker vessels. Honor them as fellow heirs of the grace of life so you don't hinder your prayers.

Interpersonal Virtues

[8]In conclusion, you need to be like-minded, sympathetic, tenderhearted, humble, with brotherly love. [9]Don't return evil for evil or insult for insult; bless instead. You were called for that so you could inherit good fortune:

[10]***"Who wants to live***
a long time and prosper?

Keep your tongue from evil
and your lips from lying.
[11]*Quit doing bad and do good;*
look for peace and pursue it.
[12]*The LORD watches over good people*
and hears their prayers.
He turns against
people that practice sin" **[Ps 34:12-16].** **1 Pet 3:7-12**

[13]Who's going to hurt you if you're eager to do what's good? [14]Even if you suffer for it, you're well off. Don't be afraid of people's evil, or let it get you down. [15-16]Set Christ apart as Lord in your hearts. With gentleness and respect, be ready to answer anybody that asks you about the hope you have. Keep your conscience clear so whatever people slander you about, your good behavior in Christ will discredit them. **1 Pet 3:13-16**

Suffering for Doing Good

[17]If God wills, it's better to suffer for being good than for being bad. [18]To bring you to God, Christ also suffered for sin once and for all, the righteous for the unrighteous. He was put to death in the flesh but made alive in the spirit. [19]He went in the spirit and preached to the spirits in prison [20]that disobeyed while God patiently waited for Noah to build the ark. In it, water saved a few people—eight. [21]That's like baptism saving you. It doesn't wash off dirt, but appeals to God for a clear conscience because of Christ's resurrection. [22]He's ascended to God's right hand in heaven with angels, authorities, and powers subject to him. **1 Pet 3:17-22**

Good News Presented to the Dead

4:[1]Christ suffered; so arm yourselves with the attitude he took, because suffering purifies from sin. [2]You won't be living the rest of your life by human desires, but by God's will. [3]You spent enough time following the pattern of life the Gentiles carry on: a lifestyle of sensuality, lust, drunkenness, revelry, drunken parties, disgusting idolatry. [4]They're surprised that you don't run with them in that excessive, reckless living; and they slander you for it. [5]They'll give account to the One who's set to judge the living and the dead. [6]In that connection, the good news was presented even to the dead so they'd be judged like the living who live according to God in the spirit. **1 Pet 4:1-6**

Living with Christ's Return in Mind

[7]The end is close. Be sensible and serious in prayer. [8]Especially, have ongoing love toward each other because love covers lots of sins. [9]Be hospitable toward each other without grudges. [10]Each of you needs to minister your gift to the others as good stewards of the grace God has shown in *these* different ways. If it's speaking, speak as if God himself is speaking. [11]If

it's serving, do it wholeheartedly. That way you'll praise God through Christ. Glory and dominion belong to him forevermore. Amen. **1 Pet 4:7-11**

Nothing Surprising About Suffering

12Don't be surprised at the fiery trial that's testing you, as if something strange is happening. **13**Instead, to the extent that you're sharing Christ's sufferings, be happy so you can be really happy when he appears in his glory. **14**If people dishonor you because of him, *you're* blessed; God's Spirit and honor rest on you. **15**Don't suffer as a murderer, thief, evildoer, intruder in other people's business. **16**If you suffer as a Christian, don't be ashamed; praise God in that name. **17**It's time to judge God's family. If judgment begins with us, what's going to happen to people that disbelieve God's good news?

18*"If good people are barely saved,*
where will godless people come in?" **[Pro 11:31 LXX]**

19So you that suffer according to God's will, entrust yourselves to the faithful creator by continuing to do what's right. **1 Pet 4:12-19**

Urging Elders

5:1 Elders, I'm a fellow elder, a witness of Christ's sufferings. I share in the glory that's going to be revealed. **2**Shepherd God's flock that's among you. Provide oversight, not because you have to, but because you want to; not to make money (which is shameful), but out of internal initiative. **3**Don't lord it over your charges; set an example for the flock. **4**When the Chief Shepherd appears, you'll receive a glorious crown that won't fade away. **1 Pet 5:1-4**

Urging Younger People

5Young men, defer to the elders and dress in humility toward each other because

"God resists the proud
and gives grace to the humble" **[Pro 3:34 LXX].**

6So "humble" yourselves under God's strong hand, and he'll exalt you in due time. **7**Place your cares on him because he cares about you. **8**Be serious-minded and alert. Your adversary the devil is prowling around looking for somebody to devour. **9**Resist him firmly with faith; you know your fellow believers in the world are experiencing the same sufferings. **10**After you've suffered a little while, the all-gracious God that has called you into his eternal glory will confirm you, strengthen you, and establish you. **11**Dominion to him forever! Amen. **1 Pet 5:5-11**

Closing Comments

12I've written you a few words by Silvanus *my* faithful brother, as I consider him. I wanted to encourage you and confirm to you that what you've received is in fact God's grace; stand firm in

it. **13**The elect brotherhood in ‘Babylon’ greets you as does my son Mark. **14**Greet each other with a loving kiss. Peace to all of you in Christ. **1 Pet 5:12-14**

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